

Ignacio Magaña Hernandez

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Pittsburgh, PA 15213

Employment

Carnegie Mellon University

McWilliams Postdoctoral Fellow

Pittsburgh, PA

June 2023 - Present

University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee

NSF Graduate Research Fellow

Milwaukee, WI

September, 2017 - May 2023

The Chinese University of Hong Kong

Undergraduate Research Assistant

Hong Kong, Hong Kong

March, 2016 - January 2017

Caltech

LIGO SURF Fellow

Pasadena, CA

June, 2015 - September, 2015

Education

University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee

PhD in Physics

Milwaukee, WI

September 2017 - May 2023

University of California, Santa Barbara

B.S., Physics (Highest Honors)

Santa Barbara, CA

September 2014 - September 2017

Foothill College

Transfer Student, Physics

Los Altos Hills, CA

September 2012 - June 2014

Awards & Fellowships

- **CMU McWilliams Postdoctoral Fellowship** 2023 - Present
McWilliams Center for Cosmology and Astrophysics three year fellowship.
- **CMU McWilliams Seed Grant** 2025
Internal grant funding exploratory projects to generate preliminary results for high impact research.
- **UWM Advanced Opportunity Program Fellowship** 2019 - 2023
UWM fellowship supporting underrepresented graduate students for three years.
- **NSF Graduate Research Fellowship** 2017 - 2023
NSF fellowship supporting graduate students for three years.
- **NASA Wisconsin Space Grant Consortium Fellowship** Summer 2020, 2021, 2022
NASA funded fellowship for graduate research in STEM at Wisconsin institutions.
- **UWM Physics Department Lichtman Fellowship** Spring 2020
Departmental fellowship awarded for exceptional academic achievement in physics.
- **UCSB Physics Department Highest Academic Honors** Summer 2017
Awarded to graduating physics students with at least a 3.9 GPA in physics courses only.
- **LIGO SURF Blanco Fellowship** Summer 2015
Summer Research Fellowship at Caltech/LIGO, supporting undergraduates in GW science.
- **UCSB Dean's list** Fall 2014 - Spring 2017
Recognition for maintaining a GPA of 3.75 per quarter.
- **NSF Science, Math and Engineering (S-STEM) Scholarship** Fall 2013 - Spring 2014
NSF scholarship providing support to students pursuing STEM degrees.

Publication Summary

h-index: 52 / 17 **Publications:** 76 / 30 **Citations:** 44k / 2.0k

First number includes LIGO collaboration papers; second number excludes them

Citations according to inspirehep.net in July 2026

First/Second Author Publications

1. *Dark siren cosmology with the Dark Energy Spectroscopic Instrument*
I. Magaña Hernandez, A. Palmese et al.
Under DESI internal review
2. *Lucky Strikes: On the Origins of GW190814 Through Isolated Binary Evolution*
I. Magaña Hernandez and K. Breivik
([arXiv:2511.16648](#), [1 citations](#)) Submitted to *ApJL*
3. *Spectral siren cosmology from gravitational-wave observations in GWTC-4.0*
I. Magaña Hernandez and A. Palmese
([arXiv:2509.03607](#), [3 citations](#)) Submitted to *Physical Review Letters*
4. *Astrophysics informed Gaussian processes for gravitational-wave populations: Evidence for the onset of the pair-instability supernova mass gap*
I. Magaña Hernandez and A. Palmese
([arXiv:2508.19208](#), [7 citations](#)) Submitted to *Physical Review Letters*
5. *A new bump in the night: evidence of a new feature in the binary black hole mass distribution at $70 M_{\odot}$ from gravitational-wave observations*
I. Magaña Hernandez and A. Palmese
Phys. Rev. D 111, 083031 (2025) ([arXiv:2407.02460](#), [10 citations](#))
6. *Searching for binary black hole sub-populations in gravitational wave data using binned Gaussian processes*
A. Ray, **I. Magaña Hernandez**, K. Breivik, J.D.E. Creighton
ApJ 991 17 (2025) ([arXiv:2404.03166](#), [31 citations](#))
7. *Beyond Gaps and Bumps: Spectral Siren Cosmology with Non-Parametric Population Models*
I. Magaña Hernandez and A. Ray
([arXiv:2404.02522](#), [24 citations](#)) Submitted to *Physical Review D*
8. *On the association of GW190425 with its potential electromagnetic counterpart FRB 20190425A*
I. Magaña Hernandez, V. D'Emilio, S. Morisaki, M. Bhardwaj and A. Palmese
ApJL 971 L5 (2024) ([arXiv:2404.02496](#), [13 citations](#))
9. *Non-parametric inference of the population of compact binaries from gravitational wave observations using binned Gaussian processes*
A Ray, **I. Magaña Hernandez**, S. Mohite, J.D.E. Creighton and S. Kapadia
ApJ 957 37 (2023) ([arXiv:2304.08046](#), [66 citations](#))
10. *Measuring the polarization content of gravitational waves with strongly lensed binary black hole mergers*
I. Magaña Hernandez
([arXiv:2211.01272](#), [11 citations](#)) Submitted to *Physical Review D*
11. *Constraining the number of spacetime dimensions from GWTC-3 binary black hole mergers*
I. Magaña Hernandez
Phys. Rev. D 107, 084033 (2023) ([arXiv:2112.07650](#), [19 citations](#))
12. *A Bayesian statistical framework for identifying strongly-lensed gravitational-wave signals*
R.K.L. Lo and **I. Magaña Hernandez**
Phys. Rev. D 107, 123015 (2023) ([arXiv:2104.09339](#), [78 citations](#))
13. *Identifying strong gravitational-wave lensing during the second observing run of Advanced LIGO and Advanced Virgo*
X. Liu, **I. Magaña Hernandez** and J.D.E. Creighton
ApJ 908 97 (2021) ([arXiv:2009.06539](#), [89 citations](#))
14. *Cosmological inference using gravitational wave standard sirens: A mock data analysis*
R. Gray, **I. Magaña Hernandez** et al.
Phys. Rev. D 101, 122001 (2020) ([arXiv:1908.06050](#), [211 citations](#))

Other Short Author Work

1. *AT2025ulz and S250818k: Investigating early time observations of a subsolar mass gravitational-wave binary neutron star merger candidate*
X. Hall et al. (including **I. Magaña Hernandez**)
([arXiv:2510.24620](#), [1 citations](#))
2. *AT2025ulz and S250818k: Deep X-ray and radio limits on off-axis afterglow emission and prospects for future discovery*
B. O'Connor et al. (including **I. Magaña Hernandez**)
([arXiv:2510.23728](#), [1 citations](#))
3. *AT2025ulz and S250818k: Leveraging DESI spectroscopy in the hunt for a kilonova associated with a sub-solar mass gravitational wave candidate*
X. Hall et al. (including **I. Magaña Hernandez**)
([arXiv:2510.23723](#), [1 citations](#))
4. *Kilonova Constraints for the LIGO/Virgo/KAGRA Neutron Star Merger Candidate S250206dm: GW-MMADS Observations*
L. Hu et al. (including **I. Magaña Hernandez**)
ApJL 990 L46 (2025) ([arXiv:2506.22626](#), [3 citations](#))
5. *A Dark Siren Measurement of the Hubble Constant with the LIGO/Virgo Gravitational Wave Event GW190412 and DESI Galaxies*
W. Ballard, A. Palmese, **I. Magaña Hernandez** et al.
Res. Notes AAS 7 250 (2023) ([arXiv:2311.13062](#), [22 citations](#))
6. *Follow-up analyses to the O3 LIGO–Virgo–KAGRA lensing searches*
J. Janquart et al. (including **I. Magaña Hernandez**)
MNRAS 526, 3832 (2023) ([arXiv:2306.03827](#), [55 citations](#))
7. *Challenges for Fast Radio Bursts as Multi-Messenger Sources from Binary Neutron Star Mergers*
M. Bhardwaj, A. Palmese, **I. Magaña Hernandez**, V. D’Emilio and S. Morisaki
ApJ 977 122 (2024) ([arXiv:2306.00948](#), [27 citations](#))
8. *Localization of binary neutron star mergers with a single Cosmic Explorer*
P. Baral, S. Morisaki, **I. Magaña Hernandez** and J.D.E. Creighton
Phys. Rev. D 108, 043010 (2023) ([arXiv:2304.09889](#), [14 citations](#))
9. *The Hitchhiker’s guide to the galaxy catalog approach for gravitational wave cosmology*
J. Gair et al. (including **I. Magaña Hernandez**)
AJ 166 22 (2023) ([arXiv:2212.08694](#), [75 citations](#))
10. *A joint ranking statistic for multi-messenger astronomical searches with gravitational waves*
B. Piotrkowski, A. Baylor and **I. Magaña Hernandez**
Class. Quantum Grav. 39 085010 (2022) ([arXiv:2111.12814](#), [8 citations](#))
11. *Rapid model comparison of equations of state from gravitational wave observation of binary neutron star coalescences*
S. Ghosh, X. Liu, J.D.E. Creighton, **I. Magaña Hernandez** et al.
Phys. Rev. D 104, 083003 (2021) ([arXiv:2104.08681](#), [23 citations](#))
12. *Gravitational wave friction in light of GW170817 and GW190521*
S. Mastroianni, L. Haegel, K. Karathanasis, **I. Magaña Hernandez** and D.A. Steer
JCAP 02 043 (2021) ([arXiv:2010.04047](#), [38 citations](#))
13. *Current observations are insufficient to confidently associate the binary black hole merger GW190521 with AGN J124942.3 + 344929*
G. Ashton, K. Ackley, **I. Magaña Hernandez** et al.
Class. Quantum Grav. 38 235004 (2021) ([arXiv:2009.12346](#), [97 citations](#))
14. *First measurement of the Hubble parameter from bright binary black hole GW190521*
S. Mukherjee et al. (including **I. Magaña Hernandez**)
([arXiv:2009.14199](#), [63 citations](#))
15. *Bayesian inference for compact binary coalescences with BILBY: Validation and application to the first LIGO–Virgo gravitational-wave transient catalogue*
I.M. Romero-Shaw et al. (including **I. Magaña Hernandez**)
MNRAS 499, 3295 (2020) ([arXiv:2006.00714](#), [492 citations](#))
16. *A statistical standard siren measurement of the Hubble Constant from the LIGO/Virgo gravitational wave compact object merger GW190814 and Dark Energy Survey galaxies*
A. Palmese et al. (including **I. Magaña Hernandez**)

ApJL 900 L33 (2020) ([arXiv:2006.14961](#), [141 citations](#))

17. *A standard siren measurement of the Hubble Constant from GW170817 without the electromagnetic counterpart*
M. Fishbach, R. Gray, **I. Magaña Hernandez** et al.
ApJL 871 L13 (2019) ([arXiv:1807.05667](#), [252 citations](#))

LIGO-Virgo Publications to which I highly contributed:

1. *GW190814: Gravitational Waves from the Coalescence of a 23 Solar Mass Black Hole with a 2.6 Solar Mass Compact Object*
LIGO Scientific and Virgo Collaborations (including **I. Magaña Hernandez**)
ApJL 896 L44 (2020) ([arXiv:2006.12611](#), [1823 citations](#)) **Led and wrote the Hubble constant analysis**
2. *A Gravitational-wave Measurement of the Hubble Constant Following the Second Observing Run of Advanced LIGO and Virgo*
LIGO Scientific and Virgo Collaborations (including **I. Magaña Hernandez**)
ApJ 909 218 (2021) ([arXiv:1908.06060](#), [386 citations](#)) **Paper writing and analysis team member**
3. *First measurement of the Hubble constant from a dark standard siren using the Dark Energy Survey galaxies and the LIGO/Virgo binary-black-hole merger GW170814*
M. Soares-Santos, A. Palmese et al. and LIGO Scientific and Virgo Collaborations (including **I. Magaña Hernandez**)
ApJL 876 L7 (2019) ([arXiv:1901.01540](#), [320 citations](#)) **Validated analysis using gwcsmo**

Invited Seminars

- | | |
|--|----------------|
| 1. American Museum of Natural History
<i>Binary black hole populations and cosmology with gravitational-wave observations and DESI</i> | October 2025 |
| 2. Vanderbilt University
<i>Binary black hole populations and cosmology with gravitational-wave observations and DESI</i> | April 2025 |
| 3. KAGRA Seminar
<i>Binary black hole populations and cosmology</i> | April 2025 |
| 4. Stanford University (KIPAC Seminar)
<i>Binary black hole populations and cosmology with gravitational-wave observations and DESI</i> | March 2025 |
| 5. Carnegie Mellon University (STAMPS Seminar)
<i>Binary black hole populations and cosmology</i> | January 2025 |
| 6. Montclair State University
<i>Cosmology, Lensing, and Modified Gravity with Gravitational Waves</i> | September 2023 |
| 7. Carnegie Mellon University
<i>Testing general relativity with strongly lensed gravitational waves</i> | September 2023 |
| 8. Cardiff University
<i>Cosmology and modified gravity with binary black holes</i> | September 2022 |
| 9. UC Berkeley
<i>Constraining the number of spacetime dimensions from GWTC-3 binary black hole mergers</i> | June 2022 |
| 10. University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee
<i>Cosmology and modified gravity with binary black hole mergers</i> | April 2022 |
| 11. Eotvos Lorand University
<i>Gravitational wave cosmology with large galaxy surveys</i> | September 2019 |
| 12. University of Glasgow
<i>Measuring the Hubble constant with gravitational-wave standard sirens</i> | August 2019 |
| 13. The Chinese University of Hong Kong
<i>A measurement of the Hubble constant from the second observation run of Advanced LIGO-Virgo</i> | February 2019 |
| 14. Nagoya University
<i>A measurement of the Hubble constant from the second observation run of Advanced LIGO-Virgo</i> | February 2019 |

Talks at Conferences

1. **Gravitational Waves Physics and Astronomy Workshop** December 2025
Dark Siren Cosmology with the Dark Energy Spectroscopic Instrument (DESI)
2. **COSMO25** October 2025
Gravitational-wave dark siren cosmology with DESI
3. **Multimessenger Astronomy in the Era of Foundational AI** August 2025
Trends in the GWTC-3 Binary Black Hole Merger Population with UMAP
4. **Summer DESI Collaboration Meeting** July 2025
Gravitational-wave cosmology with DESI
5. **APS Global Physics Summit** April 2025
Lucky Strikes: Unraveling the asymmetric origins of GW190814 through binary field evolution
6. **The 6th neighborhood workshop** April 2024
Beyond Gaps and Bumps: Spectral Siren Cosmology with Non-Parametric Population Models
7. **Gravitational-wave populations: what's next?** July 2023
Non-parametric inference of the population of compact binaries from gravitational wave observations using binned Gaussian processes
8. **APS April Meeting** April 2023
Measuring the polarization content of gravitational waves with strongly lensed binary black hole mergers
9. **11th Australasian Conference on General Relativity and Gravitation** February 2022
Constraining the number of spacetime dimensions from GWTC-3 binary black hole mergers
10. **Midwest Relativity Meeting** October 2021
Constraining the number of spacetime dimensions from GWTC-3 binary black hole mergers
11. **Midwest Relativity Meeting** October 2020
On the candidate electromagnetic counterpart of GW190521 and its implications on the Hubble constant
12. **Gravitational Waves Physics and Astronomy Workshop** October 2019
A gravitational-wave measurement of the Hubble constant following the second observing run of Advanced LIGO and Virgo
13. **Multi-Messenger Astrophysics in the Gravitational Wave Era** September 2019
A gravitational-wave measurement of the Hubble constant following the second observing run of Advanced LIGO and Virgo
14. **YITP Asian-Pacific Winter School and Workshop on Gravitation and Cosmology** February 2019
A standard siren measurement of the Hubble constant from GW170817 without the electromagnetic counterpart
15. **Midwest Relativity Meeting** October 2018
Cosmological inference using gravitational wave standard sirens: A mock data challenge
16. **19th Annual Physical Society of Hong Kong** June 2016
Feedforward Seismic Noise Cancellation at the 40m Prototype Interferometer

Posters

1. **APS Global Physics Summit** April 2025
A new bump in the night: evidence of a new feature in the binary black hole mass distribution at $70 M_{\odot}$ from gravitational-wave observations
2. **Gravitational Waves Physics and Astronomy Workshop** May 2024
Beyond Gaps and Bumps: Spectral Siren Cosmology with Non-Parametric Population Models
3. **Gravitational Waves Physics and Astronomy Workshop** May 2024
Backpop: Data Driven Population Synthesis inference on Compact Binary Mergers
4. **LVK Meeting: Cardiff University** September 2022
Measuring the polarization content of gravitational waves with strongly lensed binary black hole mergers
5. **Merging Visions: Exploring Compact-Object Binaries with Gravity and Light** June 2019
Identifying Strong Gravitational-wave Lensing during the Second Observing Run of Advanced LIGO and Advanced Virgo
6. **Gravitational Waves Physics and Astronomy Workshop** December 2018
Cosmological inference using gravitational wave standard sirens: A mock data analysis

Other Workshops

1. **Multi-messenger Transients from Binary Mergers and Stellar Explosions** August 2024
Aspen Center for Physics
2. **Black Holes and Neutron Stars with Gravitational Waves** October 2019
Yukawa Institute for Theoretical Physics
3. **The New Era of Gravitational-Wave Physics and Astrophysics** May - July 2019
Kavli Institute for Theoretical Physics
4. **Asian-Pacific Winter School and Workshop on Gravitation and Cosmology** February 2019
Yukawa Institute for Theoretical Physics
5. **Les Houches Summer School: Gravitational-Wave Astronomy** July 2018
Ecole de Physique des Houches
6. **Summer School on Gravitational-Wave Astronomy** August 2016
ICTS-TIFR

Societies/Affiliations

- Dark Energy Spectroscopic Instrument (DESI) member (June 2023 - Present)
- LIGO Scientific Collaboration member (June 2015 - June 2023)
- American Physical Society
- Society for Advancement of Chicanos/Hispanics and Native Americans in Science (SACNAS)
- National Society of Hispanic Physicists

Student Mentoring

- **Kaitlyn Pak** Carnegie Mellon University
Undergraduate student - Multi-messenger associations with GWs September 2025 - Present
- **Ariel Amsellem** Carnegie Mellon University
PhD student - Standard siren cosmology. September 2023 - Present
- **Simon Yeung** University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee
PhD student - GW population systematics. September 2023 - Present
- **Julia Yoon** Carnegie Mellon University
Undergraduate student - Dark siren cosmology with GW170817 September 2024 - May 2025
- **Diego Michel** Carnegie Mellon University
Undergraduate student - Gaussian processes for GW populations. September 2023 - May 2024
- **Anarya Ray** University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee
PhD student (co-advised) - Binned Gaussian processes for GW populations. September 2021 - June 2024
- **Pratyusava Baral** University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee
PhD student (co-advised) - Localization of BNS events with 3G GW detectors. September 2021 - May 2023
- **Brandon Piotrkowski** University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee
PhD student (co-advised) - Multi-messenger association statistics. September 2019 - February 2020

Skills

- **Programming skills:**
 - Proficiency with: Python (NumPy, SciPy, Pandas, Scikit-learn), JAX, C, Mathematica, LaTeX.
 - Familiar with: Stan, C++, MATLAB/Simulink.
 - LVK related software: Bilby, LALSuite, PyCBC, ligo.skymap, gwcosmo, hanabi.
- **Data Analysis:**
 - Bayesian model selection and parameter estimation, Monte Carlo methods.
 - Digital signal processing, machine learning, and basic numerical relativity experience.
- **Languages:** English (fluent), Spanish (fluent), Korean (intermediate), and Japanese (beginner).

References

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